ACTIVITY 073

Listen Before You Echo

Focus & Memory

5 minutes / Director and a three-note phrase.

Delay the response until the whole model has been heard.

MODEL / LISTEN

1 2 1

RESPONSE / ECHO

1 2 1

wait for cue

A raised hand keeps the group listening. Echo only after the waiting beat and response cue.

1. *Explain that a raised hand means listen and an open palm means echo.*
2. *Model a short phrase while the hand stays raised; release the echo cue after one silent beat.*
3. *Vary the phrase and the waiting beat so the choir cannot simply copy immediately.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

No one starts before the echo cue, even when the model is familiar.

COMMON TRAP

Echoing immediately because the phrase is familiar.

MAKE IT WORK

Use spoken words first and add melody later.